

Assessment Book: History

Period 1 Assessment

1. [MULTIPLE_CHOICE] Who introduced the Doctrine of Lapse?

- A. Lord Dalhousie
- B. Lord Curzon
- C. Warren Hastings
- D. Robert Clive

Answer: Lord Dalhousie

2. [SHORT_ANSWER] Define the Doctrine of Lapse and state one Indian state that was annexed under it.

Answer: The Doctrine of Lapse was a policy stating that if a ruler died without a natural male heir, his state would be annexed by the East India Company instead of passing to an adopted heir; e.g., Jhansi, Satara, or Nagpur.

3. [EXTENDED_RESPONSE] Explain how the decline of the Mughal Empire and the Doctrine of Lapse together contributed to political discontent before 1857.

Answer: The weakening Mughal Empire left a power vacuum that allowed the East India Company to expand its control. The Doctrine of Lapse let the Company annex princely states whenever a ruler died without a natural heir, removing traditional rulers and denying rights of adoption. This combination angered rulers and elites, creating widespread political resentment that fed into the causes of the Revolt of 1857.

4. [ANALYSIS] If you were an advisor to a princely ruler in the 1850s, what strategy might you suggest to protect the kingdom from annexation under the Doctrine of Lapse, and why might it fail?

Answer: Sample answer: Advise the ruler to formally adopt a natural or legally recognized heir early and seek British legal recognition of the adoption; however, this could still fail because the Company often refused to recognize adopted heirs under the Doctrine of Lapse, prioritizing annexation for territorial and revenue gains.

Period 2 Assessment

1. [MCQ] The Enfield rifle cartridges were rumoured to be greased with:

- A. Wheat flour and oil
- B. Cow and pig fat
- C. Mustard oil only
- D. Vegetable ghee

Answer: Cow and pig fat

2. [SHORT ANSWER] Why did the Enfield cartridges offend both Hindu and Muslim soldiers?

Answer: Hindus consider the cow sacred, and Muslims consider pigs impure/forbidden; since soldiers had to bite the cartridges to load the rifle, using fat from these animals violated the religious beliefs of both groups.

3. [ANALYTICAL/EXTENDED RESPONSE] Distinguish between the underlying causes and the immediate trigger of the Revolt of 1857. Using the Enfield cartridge incident, explain how a single event can escalate long-standing grievances into open rebellion.

Answer: Underlying causes (political annexation policies like Doctrine of Lapse, economic exploitation, social/religious interference, military discrimination) built resentment over years, while the Enfield cartridge rumour was the immediate spark. Because soldiers were already distrustful and resentful, the cartridge issue quickly united Hindu and Muslim sepoys and turned existing anger into active revolt, showing how a trigger ignites pre-existing conditions rather than creating grievances from nothing.

4. [TRUE/FALSE] The Enfield rifle cartridge controversy was the root cause of the Revolt of 1857, unrelated to earlier grievances.

- A. True
- B. False

Answer: False

Period 3 Assessment

1. [MCQ] Which centre is correctly matched with its leader?

- A. Kanpur - Rani Lakshmibai
- B. Jhansi - Nana Sahib

C. Lucknow - Begum Hazrat Mahal

D. Delhi - Tantia Tope

Answer: Lucknow - Begum Hazrat Mahal

2. [SHORT_ANSWER] Name the city where the revolt of 1857 began and give the date.

Answer: Meerut, 10 May 1857

3. [SHORT_ANSWER] Why was Bahadur Shah Zafar declared emperor by the rebels in Delhi, even though he had little actual power?

Answer: The rebels wanted a symbolic figure of unity and legitimacy from the old Mughal dynasty to rally support across regions, even though real political and military control remained with the local leaders.

4. [ANALYSIS] Compare the leadership roles of Rani Lakshmibai in Jhansi and Nana Sahib in Kanpur. In what way was Rani Lakshmibai's leadership described differently in historical accounts?

Answer: Both led armed resistance in their regions against the British; Nana Sahib led the uprising in Kanpur, while Rani Lakshmibai led resistance in Jhansi and is specifically described as one of the most respected leaders of the revolt, suggesting her leadership earned particular admiration and recognition.

Period 4 Assessment

1. [MULTIPLE_CHOICE] Which of the following was NOT listed as a reason for the failure of the Revolt of 1857?

A. Lack of national unity

B. Poor communication

C. Superior British military strength

D. Widespread use of modern telegraph by rebels

Answer: Widespread use of modern telegraph by rebels

2. [SHORT_ANSWER] Explain how the absence of unified leadership among the rebels weakened their ability to fight the British.

Answer: Without unified leadership, rebel groups acted independently, could not coordinate strategy or timing of

uprisings, and the British could defeat them one region at a time rather than facing a single combined force.

3. [ANALYSIS] Compare the resources and strategies of the British with those of the rebels. Give at least two points of contrast.

Answer: British had superior military strength, better weapons, organized supply lines, reinforcements, and communication networks; rebels had limited resources, poor communication, and fragmented, uncoordinated strategies across different regions.

4. [EVALUATION] Of the five reasons for failure (lack of unity, poor communication, limited resources, superior British military strength, no unified leadership), which do you think was the MOST decisive in causing the revolt's collapse? Justify your answer with reasoning.

Answer: Answers may vary; a strong response picks one factor and explains logically why it outweighed the others, e.g., arguing that lack of unity was root cause because it worsened communication, leadership, and resource-pooling problems, or arguing British military strength was decisive because even a united rebellion may have struggled against a professional, well-equipped army.

Period 5 Assessment

1. [MULTIPLE_CHOICE] Which of the following ended as a direct consequence of the Revolt of 1857?

- A. The Mughal dynasty
- B. Rule of the East India Company
- C. The British Crown's involvement in India
- D. The Indian army

Answer: Rule of the East India Company

2. [SHORT_ANSWER] In what year did the British Crown take direct control of India, and from whom did it take over?

Answer: 1858; from the East India Company

3. [SHORT_ANSWER] List two changes the British made regarding the army and Indian rulers after 1857.

Answer: Army organization was restructured; greater caution was exercised in dealing with Indian rulers.

4. [ANALYTICAL/ESSAY] The revolt of 1857 was caused by issues such as annexation of Indian states,

mistreatment of sepoys, and interference in social customs. Analyze whether the consequences (end of Company rule, Crown control, administrative reforms, army restructuring, caution with rulers) genuinely addressed these causes or mainly aimed to strengthen British control. Support your answer with at least two examples.

Answer: A strong answer explains that some measures (e.g., army restructuring, caution with rulers) responded to specific grievances but were also designed to prevent future rebellion and protect British authority, while deeper issues like economic exploitation and cultural respect were not fully resolved; administrative reforms and Crown rule mainly reorganized control rather than addressing root causes.

Period 6 Assessment

1. [MULTIPLE_CHOICE] Historians who call 1857 the 'First War of Independence' primarily emphasise:

- A. It was won decisively by Indian forces
- B. It was a widespread rebellion with lasting inspirational impact on independence movements
- C. It was limited only to soldiers' personal grievances
- D. The British initiated it to reform Indian society

Answer: It was a widespread rebellion with lasting inspirational impact on independence movements

2. [SHORT_ANSWER] Explain in 2-3 sentences why the revolt of 1857, despite failing militarily, is still considered historically important.

Answer: Although defeated, the revolt inspired later movements for independence and is regarded by many historians as a foundational moment in Indian nationalism, even though others view it as a limited military rebellion.

3. [ESSAY] Construct a well-supported argument on whether 1857 should be called a 'Sepoy Mutiny' or the 'First War of Independence'. Use evidence from the causes, major centres, reasons for failure, and consequences of the revolt to support your position.

Answer: Answers will vary; a strong response takes a clear position and supports it with at least three specific pieces of evidence drawn from causes, centres, failure, and consequences, while acknowledging the opposing view.